

1. Ruff v0.16.0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-25T22:44:05+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/25/ruff/#atom-everything>

Ruff v0.16.0 Astral shipped a significant new version of their Ruff Python linting tool a few days ago on July 23rd. I noticed today because my various CI jobs all started failing thanks to new default Ruff checks and my unpinned "ruff" dev dependency. From Brent Westbrook's announcement post: Ruff now enables 413 rules by default, up from 59 in previous versions. Since Ruff's default rule set was last modified in v0.1.0 , the number of rules in Ruff has grown from 708 to 968. Many of these rules catch severe issues, including syntax errors and immediate runtime errors but were not previously enabled by default. With the new rule set, Ruff will bring these issues and many others to your attention without any Ruff configuration. Here's a one-liner for trying it on any Python project: `uvx ruff@latest check` . I ran the latest Ruff against my three biggest projects - Datasette , sqlite-utils , and LLM - and it found hundreds of minor issues that breached the new default rules. All three projects have very comprehensive test suites, executed in CI against Python 3.10 through Python 3.14, so upgrades like this are pretty safe. The following command did the bulk of the upgrades: `uvx ruff...`

2. Quoting Linus Torvalds

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-16T13:26:10+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/16/linus-torvalds/#atom-everything>

I realize that some people really dislike AI, but this is an area where I'm willing to absolutely put my foot down as the top-level maintainer. Linux is not one of those anti-AI projects, and if somebody has issues with that, they can do the open-source thing and fork it. Or just walk away. AI is a tool, just like other tools we use. And it's clearly a useful one. It may not have been that "clearly" even just a year ago, but it's no longer in question today. There are other questions around AI (like what the economy of it will actually look like in the end), but "is it useful" is no longer one of those questions. Anybody who doubts that clearly hasn't actually used it. ? Linus Torvalds , Linux Media Mailing List Tags: open-source , linux-torvalds , linux , generative-ai , ai , llms

3. ?AI Mania Is Eviscerating Global Decision-Making?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-25T18:15:12Z

Link: <https://ludic.mataroa.blog/blog/ai-mania-is-eviscerating-global-decision-making/>

Fascinating essay by Nikhil Suresh: On a trip overseas, I had the privilege of a meeting with one of the Fortune 500 executives mentioned at the beginning of the post, who will remain anonymous so that they are not executed by firing squad by their board. As we were chatting, it became clear that they were very switched-on and technically competent, and they also happened to be at a company that had committed to the usual battery of exorbitant claims about their recent innovations ? we've 100x'd our productivity, AI is the future of everything, I am but a vessel for OpenAI to make love to my wife. You know, normal things. But since I had them there without any microphones around, I asked why this was being repeated without opposition. Was it just sales fluff? The answer was a lot more interesting. It was partially ridiculous sales material being delivered to an easily excitable audience, but this was not the dominant factor constraining honesty. Executives at their customers were saying absurd things about achieving 100x productivity, and this meant that if any executive at the vendor said that these gains were not plausible, it would undermine the credibility of the customer's ex...

4. EU Fines Google \$1 Billion for DMA Competition Violations, Including Making Search Results More Useful

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-25T17:44:13Z

Link: <https://digital-markets-act.ec.europa.eu/commission-fines-google-eur890-million-breaches->

digital-markets-act-2026-07-23_en

The European Commission on Thursday: The Commission found that Google gives preferential treatment to its own services, including shopping, hotels, transport and sports results, over those of third parties in Google Search, thereby breaching its obligations under the DMA. Google displays its own services more prominently in search results, including at the top of the search results page or by using enhanced visuals and filters, while similar third-party services do not have the same prominence. So if you search for the score of a sporting event, it's illegal in the EU for Google to show you the score, like this search I just tried . What the EC is saying is that because Google Search is so popular, it's no longer allowed to improve. It is utterly impossible to imagine how this is for the benefit of EU citizens. What generates more for the EU, fines against US tech companies, or tax income from EU tech companies? Here's a viral post on Twitter/X that claims it's now fines against US tech companies. The amounts certainly seem to be in the same ballpark. ?

5. Court Grants SerpApi's Motion to Dismiss Google Lawsuit

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-25T17:27:19Z

Link: <https://serpapi.com/blog/google-v-serpapi-the-court-granted-our-motion-to-dismiss/>

Julien Khaleghy, CEO of SerpApi: The U.S. District Court for the Northern District of California granted our motion to dismiss Google's lawsuit, marking a win not just for SerpApi, but for all who depend on an open internet. We're pleased that the court rejected Google's attempts to expand the DMCA to assert control over access to public pages. The internet's founding principle ? open access to usable information ? is essential to driving innovation and ensuring everyone benefits from the promise of data. SerpApi will continue supporting developers, AI companies, researchers, and businesses that rely on access to public search information. Yours truly, back in March, when SerpApi filed the motion to dismiss : I've come around on SerpApi in the last few months. My initial take was that it surely must be illegal for a company to scrape Google's search results and offer access to that data as an API. But I've come around to the argument that what SerpApi is doing to obtain Google search results is, well, exactly how Google scrapes the rest of the entire web to build its search index. It's all just scraping publicly accessible web pages. This December piece by Mike Masnick at Techdirt...

6. Excel column numbering

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 25 Jul 2026 13:37:30 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/25/excel-column-numbering/>

I was working with a wide spreadsheet from a client the other day and I had to convert between Excel column labels and column numbers. I had never paid attention to how Excel labels columns and implicitly thought it was base 26 using letters rather than digits. But then I realized that's not right. Excel [?] The post Excel column numbering first appeared on John D. Cook .

7. This Week in Package Management: 25 July 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-25T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/25/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week ten of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases RubyGems and Bundler 4.0.17 validate the spec name before writing to the spec cache, escape glob metacharacters in install paths, and fix a run of Windows path-handling bugs in gem open , bundle open and the MAKE / rake environment variables. uv 0.11.31 lets workspace sources reference members of a different workspace by path, supports .venv files that point at a centralised project environment, and adds audit.malware-check and audit.malware-check-url settings. There is also a preview hash-algorithm setting per index for lockfile generation. 0.11.32 followed, rejecting non-canonically formatted lockfiles in uv lock --check and regenerating them with uv lock --refresh . opam 2.6.0-alpha1 is the first alpha of the 2.6 series. The shell env hook now updates opam's bin directory in PATH in place instead of always moving it to the front, repositories are read from index.tar.gz in memory via ocaml-tar so opam update needs one syscall instead of tens of thousands on slow filesystems, and build directories are deleted sooner to cut disk use. pnpm 11.11?11...

8. Reading List 07/25/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 25 Jul 2026 14:01:08 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-072526>

China's EV subsidies, the future of aeroderivative gas turbines, a US-Saudi nuclear deal, defective roadway guardrails, and more.

9. Some Quick Thoughts on EMF Camp 2026

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 25 Jul 2026 11:34:01 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/some-quick-thoughts-on-emf-camp-2026/>

I've performed a talk at the last three EMFs - so this time I decided to go purely as a tourist. It made things much more relaxing. No waking up from a stress dream that my laptop didn't work. No casually dropping my talk into every conversation to build up an audience. No queueing for the loos five minutes before going on. No adrenaline spikes or come downs. It was bliss! After several?

10. Being Linux Torvalds

Source: antirez.com | Published: Sat, 25 Jul 2026 13:20:55 +0200

Link: <http://antirez.com/news/171>

(This blog post was adapted from the transcription obtained from my YouTube video at <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l6lxgYeVZqs>) When Linus Torvalds developed the first Linux kernel, he had studied the Minix sources, he had studied computer architecture, he had the base knowledge needed, and he was obviously a very brilliant programmer. But that operation of writing a minimal yet working Unix kernel for the 386 (at the beginning Linux was, let's say, mono-architecture) was something within the reach of many other programmers and students. Many in the sense of, I don't know, 0.1%, one in a thousand, one in ten thousand. Obviously most people are not able to do this kind of feat, but a lot of people are. If you look at Hacker News in the latest years, you'll see how many projects of kernels written in C, microkernels implemented from scratch, kernels written in Rust, kernels made in all sauces and manners, small Unix systems created vertically for the Raspberry Pi, operating systems for the ESP32 and so forth. Writing a kernel is not something within everybody's reach, but it is something that many can complete, if they put enough effort into it. Then, of course, not everybody will...

11. Pluralistic: Apple's robo-repo (25 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 25 Jul 2026 10:41:10 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/25/cruel-cruelty-oh-cruelty/>

Today's links Apple's robo-repo: Privatizing the risk premium, socializing its costs. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Printed batteries; Monopoly credit cards; Mapping airport power outlets; EMI loves pirates; Mexican indigenous phone co-op; Sewer cover textiles; Surge pricing v antitrust; Carbon offsets v forest fires; Charter schools as money laundries. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Apple's robo-repo (permalink) It may strike you as weird, but lenders love to lend money to poor people who will have trouble paying back their loans. Obviously, lenders want to be repaid, and obviously the more money you have, the easier it is to settle your debts, but (paradoxically) that means that if you have a lot of money, you expect to pay less to borrow. In other words: because poor people have a higher likelihood of defaulting, their loans come with higher interest rates and worse terms. Debt is steeply regressive: the less money you have, the m...